

Google Chrome

Although the browser is mostly open source, it includes some closed components in the version that you can download from Google. For those looking for a fully open source version, there is Chromium, which is a build made from only the open source bits of Google Chrome.

Due the extensively shared source code between Google Chrome and Chromium, these Tips and Tricks should be applicable to both. Some might even work with other Chromium-based browsers.

about:flags

While not as extensive (or true), `about:flags` can be considered the nearest equivalent of `about:config` in Firefox. Simply type `about:flags` as the URL in a new tab, and you will be greeted with a list of flags that can be toggled to enable hidden features in Google Chrome.

Some of the Tips we will use will require setting flags here. After doing so, all you need to do is restart the browser, and the new setting will come in effect. In many cases this will not be enough to activate a feature.

Tabs on the side

If you have a large monitor, you might want to switch displaying tabs on the side, in order to gain more space



Google Chrome.....	33
Firefox.....	35
NTFS.....	37
Registry.....	38
Useful tools for Twitter.....	39

for displaying tabs. Unlike with Firefox, you do not need to install an extension to get tabs on the side, as this merely requires you to toggle a flag in `about:flags`.

After you have enabled the “Side Tabs” experiment in `about:flags` simply right-click on a tab and click “Use side tabs” to switch between tabs-on-top and tabs-on-the-side.

Some of the limitations with Google’s side tabs are:

- If you open too many tabs, and the number of tabs is more than what can be displayed in the vertical space available, the list of tabs will

not scroll, and some tabs will be inaccessible.

- You cannot resize the horizontal space available for tabs.



Initial settings

- The right-click menu while working with side-tabs is not very clear, it still contains “Close tabs to the Right” which no longer makes sense.

Use multiple Profiles

This is quite simple with Firefox since it has a profile manager. However, it is not too complicated for Google Chrome either. Soon it might get even simpler as Google Chrome gets its own profile manager, which promises to make it more pow-

erful than the one with Firefox.

Google Chrome has a command-line parameter `--user-data-dir` that can be used for this purpose.

To create a new profile with Google Chrome, first of all, create a new directory to hold this profile data. Let us assume you wish to store the data for your new profile in `D:\Chrome`. In this case create a shortcut to Google Chrome—you could copy your existing desktop shortcut and edit it—and add the following parameter:

`--user-data-dir=D:\Chrome`

Your full path should look something like:

`"C:\Documents and Settings\username\Local Settings\Application Data\Google\Chrome\Application\chrome.exe" --user-data-dir=D:\Chrome`

Whenever you want to



You are warned before proceeding

launch Google Chrome with this profile, simply use this shortcut. You can create multiple folders and multiple shortcuts for each profile.

If you'd prefer to use a ready-made tool for this job instead of mucking about with command-line parameters and shortcuts, you can take a look at ChromeDeck, which is an open source project for managing Google Chrome profiles.

Enable Sync

Chances are you use multiple